

CURRENT AFFAIRS



**WHY ?
&
HOW ?**



12th WEEK

18th March to 24th March, 2019

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Million Loan with China

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Islamic State Final Defeat

The RBI received \$16.31 billion in bids for the auction for a notified amount of \$5 billion. In turn, RBI infused Rs. 34,561 Cr rupee liquidity.



State Bank of India



The participating banks have to bid in the auction by quoting a forward premium in terms of paisa that they will pay to buy back the dollars.

622 **ISSUE**

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) had classified IDBI Bank as a private lender in view of Government stake falling below 51% after acquisition by the LIC.

WHAT ARE THE REASONS?

- A bank ceases to be a Public Sector Bank once the Government stake in it falls below 51%, as in the case of IDBI Bank.
- However, LIC is a fully government-owned entity and controls 51% stake in IDBI Bank.

**WHAT AIBEA SAYS?**

Even though the Government's stake has come below 51%, LIC, which is the main share-holder, is also a 100% Government corporation and hence, the re-categorisation is unwarranted and motivated against public interest.



A Bomb Cyclone swept through U.S. Great Plains, resulting in blizzard conditions.



WHAT DO YOU UNDERSTAND BY BOMB CYCLONE?

- It happens, when a storm creates a sharp rapid drop in the atmospheric pressure i.e., it can be said as a rapidly intensifying low pressure winter storm.
- Bombogenesis occurs when a non-tropical storm experiences at least a 24 millibar (the unit used to measure barometric pressure) drop within 24 hours.
- It is also known as winter hurricane.
- During the winter, the relatively warm air coming off the ocean and the cold air above land can collide to create a sharp drop in atmospheric pressure.

The decision to hold Sary-Arka-Antiterror 2019, the first joint military exercise of Shanghai Cooperation Organization was announced at the 34th meeting of RATS Council, held in Tashkent, Uzbekistan.



SALIENT POINTS

All the Member States will participate in a joint counter-terrorism exercise, Sary-Arka-Antiterror, 2019.



SARY-ARKA-ANTITERROR 2019: SCO TO CONDUCT JOINT ANTI-TERRORISM EXERCISE



SCO is a Eurasian political, economic and military organisation for making joint efforts to maintain and ensure peace, security and stability in the region.

SHANGHAI COOPERATION ORGANIZATION

- It is a permanent inter-governmental international organisation formed in 2001.
- It is established to ensure greater Coordination among the major powers in the Eurasian Region.
- It was preceded by the Shanghai Five Mechanism.
- The SCO's official languages are Russian and Chinese.
- The Heads of State Council (HSC) is the supreme decision-making body in the SCO and it meets once a year.
- SCO comprises Eight Member States i.e., India, Kazakhstan, China, Kyrgyzstan, Pakistan, Russian, Tajikistan and Uzbekistan.



REGIONAL ANTI-TERRORIST STRUCTURE (RATS)

- RATS is a permanent organ, which serves to promote cooperation of Member States against three evils of terrorism, separatism and extremism.
- The Executive Committee of the Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure (RATS) is based in Tashkent.
- The SCO Secretary-General and the Director of the Executive Committee of the SCO RATS are appointed by the Council of Heads of State for a term of three years.

GST Council in its 34th meeting discussed the operational details of implementation of the recommendations made by the Council in its 33rd meeting for lowering the GST rate of under-construction houses and affordable houses.



SALIENT POINTS

- For under-construction houses, GST is 5% without input tax credit and for affordable houses, it is 1% without input tax credit.
- The promoters shall be given a one-time option to continue to pay tax at the old rates for the on-going projects.
- For the new constructions starting from 1st April, 2019, the new GST rate structure will be applicable.

WHAT IS THE PREVIOUS GST ARCHITECTURE FOR FLATS / HOUSES / BUILDINGS?

1 COMPLETED PROPERTY

Sale of ready to move in or completed property does not attract GST, if the sale takes place after the issuance of completion certificate.



2 NORMAL HOUSES

It is 18% on two-thirds of the property value, with one-third deemed to be the value of land or undivided share of land supplied to the buyer. Effectively it comes to 12%.



3 AFFORDABLE HOUSING

GST is payable at 12% on two-thirds of the property value with one-third deemed to be the value of land or undivided share of land supplied to the buyer. Effectively it comes to 8%.



India slipped seven spots from last year in the UN World Happiness Report, 2019.

Happiness scoreboard

The gap between the top and bottom countries is wide



SALIENT POINTS

- It is topped by Finland for the second year in a row.
- Now, India stands at 140th place.
- The Report is produced by the United Nations Sustainable Development Solutions Network in partnership with the Ernesto Illy Foundation.
- March 20 is the World Happiness Day.

It used data from the Gallup World Poll.

MORE ON WORLD HAPPINESS REPORT, 2019



- 1 Six variables
 - Well Being
 - Income
 - Freedom
 - Trust
 - Healthy Life Expectancy
 - Social Support and Generosity

- 2 Overall World Happiness has fallen over the past few years.
- 3 The present report ranks the World's 156 countries on "how happy their citizens perceive themselves to be".
- 4 It said that there is increase in negative emotions, including worry, sadness and anger.
- 5 Pakistan ranked 67th, Bangladesh 125th and China at 93rd.

India Post released a special stamp cover on Ice Stupa in Leh at an event in the presence of Himalayan Institute of Alternatives, Ladakh founder, Sonam Wangchuk.



SALIENT POINTS

- Ice stupas referred to the artificial glaciers, which freeze and hold the water during the winter.
- They are conical mounds of ice.
- They start melting slowly during the summer in times of irrigation needs.

It stores water in the shape of a cone that offers minimum surface area to the sun whilst holding high volume of water.



SONAM WANGCHUK



SONAM WANGCHUK



- In '3 Idiots', he was the inspiration for the character, Phunsukh Wangdu.
- Graduated from NIT, Srinagar.
- He found Students' Educational and Cultural Movement of Ladakh (SECMoL) in 1988.
- He focussed on local knowledge for answers to the challenges posed by the difficult terrain.
- In 2013, he built the prototype of Ice stupa, to meet the demand for water in Ladakh.
- He is setting up Rs. 150 Cr Himalayan Institute of Alternatives, Ladakh, 14 kms from Leh in Phyang Valley.

Italy and China want to revive the spirit of the Ancient Silk Road, by deepening their trade and investment ties, Chinese President Xi Jinping said, during his trip to Rome.



SALIENT POINTS

- Italy became the first member of the G7 industrialized nations to join China's Belt and Road Infrastructure Project.
- The Chinese President says, they want to revitalize the ancient Silk Road in order to better share the fruits of humanity's progress.
- A total of 29 deals amounting to \$ 2.8 billion were signed during Chinese President, Xi Jinping's visit to Rome.



Sri Lanka signed \$ 989 million loan with China's Exim Bank.



THE EXPORT-IMPORT BANK OF CHINA

SALIENT POINTS

- This is for building a highway linking the centre of the Indian Ocean island to Hambantota port.
- The highway is planned from the port of Hambantota, to a planned industrial zone in the central region of Kandy.
- This is the single largest investment approved by the Exim Bank of China for Sri Lanka.
- The agreement is part of China's latest push in Sri Lanka.

The Kurdish led Syrian Democratic Forces says the Islamic State's 5 year Caliphate is over after the militants' defeat in Syria.



SALIENT POINTS

- SDF fighters have been raising victory flags in Baghuz, the last stronghold of the Jihadist group.
- However, Islamic State remains a major global security threat.
- They are active in countries from Nigeria to Philippines.
- At its height, Islamic State controlled 88,000 Sq km of land stretching across Syria and Iraq.

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